

MDIA 201 Media in Aotearoa New Zealand Course Outline 2023, Trimester 1

Course title	Media in Aotearoa New Zealand		
Short title	Media in Aotearoa NZ	Points value	20
Course coordinator	Peter Thompson	NZQF level	7
Contact details:	Peter.thompson@vuw.ac.nz phone 04 463 6827 Office hours: By appointment		
Qualification schedule:	BA (Media Studies Major)		
Prerequisites, corequisites, restrictions	N/A		
Prescription	The course explores the media industries in Aotearoa New Zealand through a series of case studies, including television, radio, newspapers, telecommunications, and film. These are discussed in terms of how ownership, regulation, funding/revenue, cultural norms and technological convergence affect media practices. The course will include consideration of how the NZ media sector is influenced by global media markets, how media value chains are changing in response to new media and evolving audience demands, and the public policy issues these raise (e.g. cultural identity, democratic engagement and Māori representation). The course will include input from industry experts where relevant.		
Student workload hours	200	Contact Hours	
Teaching/learning summary This course will primarily be delivered through a weekly 2-hour lecture (in class plus on Zoom) plus a 50-minute tutorial via Zoom (weeks 2-11.) Lectures will be recorded but not the tutorials.		Lectures	24
		Tutorials	10
		TOTAL	34
Course learning objectives (CLOs)	Students who pass this course should be able to:		
1	Demonstrate a sound knowledge of the particular industrial, regulatory, policy and technological factors that inform media production in Aotearoa New Zealand.		
2	Demonstrate historical knowledge of the wider social processes that inform the production and consumption of New Zealand media		
3	Source and evaluate relevant documentation/data on selected media institutions.		
4	Discuss the cultural and democratic significance of locally-produced content and the role of Māori and/or Pacific Island media.		

Mandatory course requirements	In addition to achieving an overall pass mark of 50%, students must:
Attend engage with all the guest seminars (to be confirmed)- preferably in person but if not, then via Zoom- in order to access expertise not generally available from academic resources.	

Course Dates	27 February- 24 June 2023
Lecture Time/ Place	Mondays, 1.10 – 3.00pm –Murphy LT220 Kelburn Campus
Lecture & Tutorial Zoom Link (password mdia201)	https://vuw.zoom.us/j/93580483774?pwd=ZjA3TC9lc3A4aXB5ODRlUkZBQmRkdz09

Additional Course Information
All additional information will be made available through Nuku/Canvas. If you do not intend to use your VUW student email it is important that you set up a forward to your regular email so you do not miss course notices.

Assessment Items		%	CLOs	Due Date
1	Media sector policy report	30%	1-2	24 March, 5pm
2	Essay	40%	1-4	26 May, 5pm
3	Online Test	30%	1-4	19 June, 1-3pm

Assessment Information	
Assignment 1: Media Institution Report 1250-1500 words Submit the assessment through the link on Nuku/Canvas on or before the due date.	
Assignment 2: Essay 2250-2500 words Submit the assessment through Turnitin on Nuku on or before the due date.	
Assignment 3: Online Test (2 hours) This will be multiple choice/open book- to be completed online.	

Assessment Guidelines
Assignment 1: Media Institution Report 1250-1500 words Write a report on a media institution which operates in Aotearoa New Zealand. This could be a television or radio operator, a newspaper/publisher, a video-on-demand service, a telecommunications/internet service provider or other online services provider/platform. Alternatively, you can opt for a media regulator or funding agency. Your report should be structured as follows- each section should be roughly 150-200 words (this may vary depending on the example- you may have more to say about one part than others): - Introduction- give a brief overview of the institution, including the media subsector(s) it operates in, and the services/functions it provides. - Identify its <i>ownership structure</i> (or identify the government or industry body which has oversight of it) How does this influence its functions and operational priorities and has anything changed recently? - Identify its <i>business model</i> or <i>revenue streams/sources</i>- how does it generate (or disburse) revenue and what does this depend on (e.g. advertising, government subsidies)? How does this influence its functions and operational priorities and has anything changed recently? - Identify what <i>regulatory frameworks</i> apply to the institution (or if a regulator/funding agency, what regulatory and funding mechanisms does it administer or oversee?). How does this influence its functions and operational priorities and has anything changed recently? - Identify which platforms and levels of the value-chain does it operates on (or have jurisdiction over if a regulator) Does it primarily focus on broadcast, print, or online services, and does it produce content, aggregate third party content, distribute content, provide a platform for third party services? How does this influence its functions and operational priorities and has anything changed recently? - Identify its normative outlook (for example, does it operate commercially, does it have a public service obligation, is it committed to serving a particular community?). How does this influence its functions and operational priorities and has anything changed recently? - Comment on the position of the institution within the media sector (is it a dominant incumbent or a struggling new market entrant?), who/what are its major competitors or stakeholders (if any) and consider what challenges the institution may face over the next 5-10 years (e.g. declining audiences, new policies, increasing competition from online platform?). - Include a reference list- any style is acceptable so long as it is consistent.
Assignment 2: Essay 2250-2500 words Write an academic essay on a topic related to the themes we have covered in Media in Aotearoa.

Format the essay as follows:

- i) Introduction and thesis statement including the aim of the essay and why you consider the topic important;
- ii) Identify your theoretical/conceptual framework (are you taking a liberal, critical or institutionalist approach) and any normative assumptions (e.g. are you assuming public service or liberal/ free market principles). You should include at least two academic references here.
- iii) Introduce your case study or examples and provide some context about them (you can consider some of the key themes from assignment 1 but you don't need discuss all of these). You should include at least two references here (not necessarily academic- industry or government documents are fine).
- iv) Discuss the key issues pertaining to the case/examples using relevant concepts, and identify the central arguments or debates underpinning them (e.g. is the media market competition functioning well, do we need more/different regulation or public funding?)
- v) Draw some conclusions about the case you have covered (if you like you can make recommendations about what might need to change, either in respect to industry practices or government policy).
- vi) Include a reference list- any style is acceptable so long as it is consistent.

Suggested Assignment 2 Essay Topics

(See course coordinator if you want to negotiate a different topic)

1. Develop your first assignment (not just cut & paste) and expand the discussion of your selected media institution, focusing on two or three of the main themes (ownership, funding, regulation, platforms, normative outlook) and expanding the discussion of its place in the relevant media sector and how it is evolving in response to changes in the media ecology.
2. Choose a topic from the list below, or if you have a specific interest not covered here, negotiate a different topic from the course coordinator:
 - a. What are the arguments for or against the Aotearoa New Zealand Public Media Bill which was intended to create a new public media entity encompassing RNZ and TVNZ?
 - b. Critically assess the role of NZ on Air and/or Te Māngai Pāho and/or the NZ Film Commission in the digital media ecology.
 - c. Discuss the main institutional changes in Whakaata Māori (the Māori Television Service) since it was established in 2004.
 - d. Critically assess the role of the National Pacific Radio Trust in the digital media ecology.
 - e. How have newspapers in Aotearoa New Zealand responded to the capture of digital advertising by major online platforms?
 - f. How is the rapid expansion of subscription video-on-demand services related to the Ultra-Fast Broadband initiative?
 - g. Discuss two examples of how digital convergence has affected the business models and value chains of media in Aotearoa New Zealand?

Assignment 3: Online Test 2 hours (online via Nuku)

- This will be multiple choice/open book- to be completed online.
- You are required to complete the test on your own and without collaboration or assistance from others. Note the questions and answers are randomized so both the sequence and response options will be different for everyone (so no phoning a friend!!)
- The test primarily covers the material covered in weeks 1-11 but may assume some knowledge of the core readings.

Marking Criteria

Marking Criteria: Assignment grading will take account of:

- Evidence of understanding and application of relevant theories/concepts/methods.
- Overall rigour of analysis and coherence of argumentation.
- Evidence of engagement with relevant readings and source material/documentation.
- Quality and coherence of writing including accurate expression and academic referencing.
- Overall effort and quality of engagement/participation.

Marking Scale:

A+ 90-100%, **A** 85-89%, **A-** 80-84%, **B+** 75-79%, **B** 70-74%, **B-** 65-69%, **C+** 60-64%, **C** 55-59%, **C-** 50-54% (Grades of C- and above are passes, otherwise: **D** 40-49%, **E** 0-39%)

Late Submissions, Extensions, Plagiarism, Penalties

Deadlines & Late Submissions

Assessed work submitted after the deadline will be penalised by a 2.5 percent deduction from your total mark per work day. Late work also receives only minimal comments from your marker.

Extensions

In *exceptional and unforeseen circumstances* an extension may be granted. (Note that you are expected to manage your time, so regular/routine commitments such as work are **not** usually counted as exceptional or unforeseen). If you require an extension, please contact the course coordinator, if possible before the assignment due date. Note that in some instances, especially requests for longer extensions, you may be asked to provide relevant documentation (e.g. a doctor's certificate or counsellor's note) where appropriate.

Please note that if you need medical or counselling services, Mauri Ora offers free and confidential consultations to registered students: <https://www.wgtn.ac.nz/student-health-counselling>

Plagiarism and unfair academic practices

Students found to have breached VUW rules on academic integrity (e.g. copying someone else's work and presenting it as your own) will fail the assessment in question and, in serious cases, may be subject to further disciplinary proceedings. Note that this includes the use of ChatGPT or similar technologies to generate any part of an assignment intended to represent your own work.

Note that Turnitin generates originality reports on assignments, based on a global database of academic and online resources. The VUW policy on plagiarism can be found here:

<https://www.victoria.ac.nz/students/support/student-interest-and-conflict-resolution/academic-integrity>

Note also that the online test must be completed on your own without assistance from or collaboration with others. Any attempt to communicate with other students or seek/provide assistance to someone else while the test is active will be considered academic misconduct.

Submission & Return of Work

Written assessment work must be submitted via the assignment upload links on (or before) the due date. Note all written assignments will be checked using Turnitin to ensure originality of work. Please include your *name, course and assignment identifier in the name of the file you upload* (e.g. "Jan Brown MDIA201 Assignment 1") Feedback on the written assignments will be provided online and/or through feedback in the seminars.

The online test will be submitted through the link when you complete and submit it.

Student Feedback

You are welcome to contact the course coordinator at any time.

A student representative for the course will be elected in the first week or two and before the mid-trimester trimester, they will solicit class feedback pass on any comments or suggestions.

There will also be an opportunity to complete an online evaluation of the course and the teaching near the end of trimester.

Communication of Additional Information

All course related information, and any additional information that students may find useful, will be available on the MDIA 201 Nuku/ Canvas site.

Lecture slides will be uploaded to Canvas soon after the lecture. Please note that these are an outline only and must not be considered an adequate substitute for regular participation in class. If you miss class for any reason, it is your responsibility to catch up on reading and seminar content.

If you are not going to use the VUW student email address set up for you, please make sure you set up a forward from the Victoria email system to the email address you do regularly use. It is recommended that

you familiarise yourself with the course outline, and to check Canvas announcements and e-mails at least one a week.

Course readings/ texts

There is a selection of course readings in TALIS linked via Canvas/Nuku Most of these are available as electronic downloads through TALIS, although copyright restrictions mean some material will need to be sourced directly through the VUW Library or other sources.

Recommended source on NZ media ownership:

AUT Centre for Journalism Media & Democracy (JMA)D)- Annual New Zealand Media Ownership Reports: <https://www.jmadresearch.com/new-zealand-media-ownership> (NB- it's worth checking out older ones to see how things have changed!)

Lecture Schedule & Readings-

(NB this may be subject to revision depending on guest speaker availability)

Wk	Date	Seminar Topic	Readings (note these are by no means exhaustive and you are encouraged to read further around your assignment topics)
1	27 Feb	Introduction- The Media Ecology in Aotearoa /NZ	- Hope, W. & Peters, R. (Eds) (2022) Aotearoa New Zealand Media Ownership Report. Auckland: JMA)D/AUT. https://www.jmadresearch.com/files/ugd/a95e86_131d36c434db480fbbb90e84ed430b14.pdf - NZ on Air/Glasshouse (2021) Where are the Audiences? https://www.nzonair.govt.nz/research/where-are-audiences-2021/ - Hirst, M., Hope, W. & Thompson, P. (2016) Australia and New Zealand. In B.Birkinbine, R. Gomez & J. Wasko (Eds) Global Media Giants. New York: Routledge. pp. 351-365
2	6 March	Approaches to Analysing Media Institutions in Aotearoa/NZ	- Thompson, P.A. (2012) Last Chance To See? Public Broadcasting Policy and the Public Sphere in New Zealand. In M. Hirst, S. Phelan & V. Rupar (Eds) Scooped: The Politics and Power of Journalism in Aotearoa New Zealand. pp 96-113. - Babe, R. (1995) On Political Economy. Chapter 5 in R. Babe, Communication and the Transformation of Economics- Essays in Information, Public Policy and Political Economy. Boulder, Co: Westview Press. pp. 69-85 - Hope.W, & Myllylahti. M. (2013). Financialisation of Media Ownership in New Zealand. New Zealand Sociology 28(3): 192-207.
3	13 March	Convergence and Value-Chains	- Doyle, G. (2013) Introduction + Convergence and Multi-Platform. In G. Doyle. Understanding Media Economics (2nd ed). London: Sage. - Hess, T. & Matt, C. (2013) The Internet and the Value Chains of the Media Industry. Chapter 4 in S. Diehl & M. Karmasin (Eds) Media and Convergence Management. Heidelberg: Springer. pp. 37-55 https://link.springer.com/content/pdf/10.1007/978-3-642-36163-0.pdf?pdf=button - Thompson, P.A. (2017) Pie in the Sky- The political economy of the failed Vodafone-Sky merger. Medianz 17(1): 28-73. Available at: https://medianz.otago.ac.nz/medianz/article/view/180
4	20 March	Radio-Analogue in the Digital Era	- McEwan, R. & Mollgaard, M. (2021) "Dollars and Listeners": Revisiting the Great New Zealand Radio Experiment of Market Deregulation, Journal of Radio & Audio Media 28(1):162-181 - McEwen, R. (2017) Renegotiating radio work in the era of media convergence: Uncertainty, individualisation and the centrality of brands. The Political Economy of Communication 5(2): 45-66 http://www.polecom.org/index.php/polecom/article/view/84/287 - Mollgaard, M. (2015). Pop, Power and Politics: Kiwi FM and the 'Third Way' in New Zealand. MEDIANZ 15(2): 50-77 https://openrepository.aut.ac.nz/handle/10292/9730

5	27 March	Broadcasting-Public Service v Commercial	- Thompson, P.A. (2019) The Return of Public Media Policy in New Zealand: New Hope or Lost Cause? <i>Journal of Digital Media & Policy</i> 10.1: 89-107. https://www.ingentaconnect.com/content/intellect/jdmp/2019/00000010/00000001/art00008 - Thompson, P.A (2019) MediaWorks Television: Death of a Thousand Cuts. Special report for The Policy Observatory. https://thepolicyobservatory.aut.ac.nz/publications/mediaworks-television-death-of-a-thousand-cuts - Thompson, P.A. (2012) Last Chance To See? Public Broadcasting Policy and the Public Sphere in New Zealand. In M. Hirst, S. Phelan & V. Rupar (Eds) <i>Scooped: The Politics and Power of Journalism in Aotearoa New Zealand</i>. pp 96-113.
6	3 April	News from Everywhere?	- Richards, I. & Rupar, V. (2021). Australia and New Zealand: A Resurgence of Public Interest in Media Performance. Chapter 6 in S. Fengler, T. Eberwein & M. Karmasin (Eds.) <i>The Global Handbook of Media Accountability</i>. Abingdon: Routledge. pp. 97-106. - Myllylahti (2018) Google, Facebook and New Zealand News Media: The problem of platform dependency. AUT Policy Observatory Report. https://thepolicyobservatory.aut.ac.nz/data/assets/pdf_file/0017/202841/google-facebook-and-new-zealand-news-media-merja-myllylahti.pdf - Ross, T. (2017) Talking about identity, community and belonging: The locative practices of Pacific news media in Aotearoa New Zealand. <i>Journal of Alternative & Community Media</i> 2(1): 89-100. https://intellectdiscover.com/content/journals/10.1368/joacm_000351
Mid trimester break 7 April-23 April			
7	24 April	Funding Local Content	- Crawford, H. (2020) NZ Media Fund Review. Report Commissioned by NZ On Air, November. https://www.nzonair.govt.nz/documents/641/NZ_Media_Fund_review_final.pdf - Crawford, J. (2021) The Public Interest Journalism Fund: Stakeholder Consultation and Recommendations Summary: Report Commissioned by NZ On Air, March. https://www.nzonair.govt.nz/documents/648/Stakeholder_consultation_report_on_PIJF_FINAL.pdf - Thompson, P.A. (2021) Public Service or Corporate Welfare? The Political Economy of State Funding for Media in an Era of Crisis. Paper #979 presented to the Political Economy Section IAMCR Conference. July 2021.
8	1 May	Māori and Pacific Media	- Smith, J. (2016) 5 Frameworks for Understanding Māori Television/ Putting the 5 Frameworks to Use. In J. Smith, <i>Māori Television-the first ten years</i>. Auckland: Auckland University Press. pp. 1-7, 144-160. - McEwen, R. (2019) Iwi radio in the era of media convergence: The opportunities and challenges of becoming 'more than radio'. <i>Pacific Journalism Review</i> 25(1-2) 139-157. https://ojs.aut.ac.nz/pacific-journalism-review/article/view/469 - Ross, T. (2019) Pulled two Ways: Norms of 'Pacificness' and Journalism in New Zealand's Pacific News Media, <i>Journal of Intercultural Studies</i>, 40(6) 649-664
9	8 May	Media Mergers & Competition	- Phelan, S. (2016) It's Neoliberalism, Stupid! New Zealand Media and the NZME-Fairfax Merger. <i>Counterfutures</i> 2:193-202. Available at: http://counterfutures.nz/2/phelan.pdf - Thompson, P.A. (2017) Pie in the Sky- The political economy of the failed Vodafone-Sky merger. <i>Medianz</i> 17(1): 28-73. Available at: https://medianz.otago.ac.nz/medianz/article/view/180 - Myllylahti, M. (2017) The Rise of Tactical Partnerships: Media Converging Beyond Ownership. <i>Medianz</i> 17(1) 74-92. https://medianz.otago.ac.nz/medianz/article/view/181/168
10	15 May	Telecommunications- the wiring under	Thompson, P.A. (2014) Wired Up or Wind-Up? The Political Economy of Broadband Policy in New Zealand. In <i>Media International Australia</i> (special edition on Broadband Futures: Content, Connectivity and Control) No.151: 146-156.

		the board	- Milner, M (2020) Ultra-Fast Broadband- The New Zealand Experience. Journal of Telecommunications and the Digital Economy 8(2): 31-55. https://search.informit.org/doi/epdf/10.3316/informit.282773990440895 - Thompson, P.A. (2019) Beware of Geeks Bearing Gifts: Assessing the Regulatory Response to the Christchurch Call. The Political Economy of Communication 7(1): 83-104. https://www.polecom.org/index.php/polecom/article/view/105/314
11	22 May	Negotiable topic	TBC
12	29 May	Revision session	
Study & Exam Period			
Monday 19 June	Online Test 1pm- 3pm	See Canvas for online test information	